Puppy's First 30 Days

The Printable Pack

Three printables for the first month. The daily schedule, the potty log, and the socialization tracker. Print the log and the tracker as many times as you need — a fresh potty log every week is the whole point.

What's inside

1. The full first-30-days schedule — a day template, a week-by-week plan, and a 30-day tracker.
2. The full potty log — a weekly grid and a blank daily sheet to photocopy.
3. The socialization tracker — every person, sound, place, and dog to meet while the window is open.

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1. The First-30-Days Schedule

The schedule runs on one rule: out on waking, after meals, after naps, after play, before bed, and every two hours between. A puppy's bladder holds for about one hour per month of age, plus one, so an eight-week-old puppy can hold it roughly two to three hours while awake. That number is your schedule. The times below are a template for an eight-week-old puppy in a household that wakes around six. Shift the whole day to fit your wake-up time — the gaps between trips matter more than the clock.

A day in the first month

Time	What happens
6:00 a.m.	Wake up. Straight outside to the same spot. Same word. Treat when they go.
6:15 a.m.	Breakfast in the crate. Fresh water down.
6:45 a.m.	Outside again — after the meal. Short play, then a nap in the crate.
8:30 a.m.	Out on waking from the nap. Five-minute training session (sit).
9:00 a.m.	Play, then a chew toy in the pen while you get on with your morning.
10:30 a.m.	Outside. Then a nap.
12:00 p.m.	Out on waking. Lunch in the crate (meal two of three or four).
12:30 p.m.	Outside after lunch. Short walk in the yard or one block.
1:30 p.m.	Outside. Then a nap. This is usually the long afternoon sleep.
3:30 p.m.	Out on waking. Five-minute training session (come).
4:30 p.m.	Outside. Play session — this is when the energy shows up.
5:30 p.m.	Dinner in the crate (meal three). Fresh water.
6:00 p.m.	Outside after dinner. Short walk or a sit on a bench somewhere new.
7:00 p.m.	Outside. Then the evening wind-down — a frozen Kong in the pen.
8:00 p.m.	Last big play, then a short training session (leave it).
8:30 p.m.	Last trip outside before bed. Pick the water bowl up about an hour before bed.
9:00 p.m.	Bedtime in the crate, next to your bed. Your worn T-shirt inside.
1:00–2:00 a.m.	Overnight trip if they stir and cry hard. Straight out, straight back, no playing.

If you miss a trip and there's an accident, clean it with the enzyme cleaner and say nothing about it. The fix is a trip fifteen minutes earlier tomorrow, not a lecture.

Week by week

Week	Focus
Week 1 Days 1–7	Settle in. Crate in the bedroom, same spot, same word, treat every time. Three five-minute training sessions a day, starting with sit and come. One new sound at low volume during dinner, one new place from a bench. First vet visit, vaccine dates written down.
Week 2 Days 8–14	The routine starts to stick. The puppy walks into the crate on their own sometimes. Sit on the lure. Ten new people met, at least one calm adult dog. Night crying down to a few minutes or nothing. Keep the two-hour trips — don't stretch them yet.
Week 3 Days 15–21	The puppy's name means something now. They look at you when you say it. They come to you in the house when you call. First round of shots done. Accidents down to one or two a day. Add a new place every couple of days and keep the five-second greetings.
Week 4 Days 22–30	Sleeping through most of the night. Sit on the word, not just the lure. Leash walks in the yard without pulling the whole time. Three or four new places visited, vacuum, hair dryer, and a thunderstorm recording heard without panicking. Book the next vet visit and find a puppy class.

30-day tracker — tick a box each day

One row per day. Tick the boxes you did, and jot one line in the notes column — what worked, what went wrong, what to change tomorrow.

Day	Out on schedule	Training done	New person or place	Notes
Day 1				
Day 2				
Day 3				
Day 4				
Day 5				
Day 6				
Day 7				
Day 8				
Day 9				
Day 10				
Day 11				
Day 12				

Day	Out on schedule	Training done	New person or place	Notes
Day 13				
Day 14				
Day 15				
Day 16				
Day 17				
Day 18				
Day 19				
Day 20				
Day 21				
Day 22				
Day 23				
Day 24				
Day 25				
Day 26				
Day 27				
Day 28				
Day 29				
Day 30				

2. The Full Potty Log

The log works because patterns hide in plain sight. A puppy who has an accident at 4 p.m. three days in a row isn't being bad. They're telling you 4 p.m. is a bathroom time you missed. Write it down for a week and the schedule writes itself. Mark each trip with a P for pee, a number 2 for poop, or an A for accident, and add a short note when something is worth remembering — "sniffed but didn't go," "missed the window."

Weekly grid — one week per sheet

Time	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
6:00 a.m.							
7:30 a.m.							
9:00 a.m.							
10:30 a.m.							
12:00 p.m.							
1:30 p.m.							
3:00 p.m.							
4:30 p.m.							
6:00 p.m.							
7:30 p.m.							
9:00 p.m.							
Overnight							

Week of: _____ Puppy's age: _____ weeks

Daily sheet — photocopy this page

Use one sheet per day when you want more detail than the grid holds.

Time	Out?	Went?	Accident?	Notes

Time	Out?	Went?	Accident?	Notes

Date: _____ Accidents today: _____ Trips out today: _____

3. The Socialization Tracker

There is a window in a puppy's life when their brain is built to meet the world, and then it closes. It runs from about three weeks old to about fourteen weeks old, and by sixteen weeks it's mostly shut. Your puppy is eight to twelve weeks old right now. You are standing in the middle of the window. Everything they meet in these weeks gets filed under "normal." Everything they don't meet gets filed under "suspicious." That filing system lasts for years.

How to use this tracker: introduce one or two new things a day, at the puppy's pace. Keep greetings to five seconds — five seconds is enough for two dogs to say hello, and enough for a stranger to pet the puppy and move on. If the puppy is scared, add distance and let them watch from where they feel safe. Never drag a scared puppy toward the thing they're afraid of. Mark the date you introduced each one, and how the puppy took it: calm, nervous, or scared.

People

Met this	Date	Reaction: calm / nervous / scared	Notes
Man with a beard			
Woman with a hat			
Child (supervised, calm)			
Older person			
Person in a uniform			
Person with an umbrella			
Person with sunglasses			
Person in a wheelchair or using a cane			
Jogger passing by			
Cyclist passing by			
Delivery driver at the door			
Friend visiting the house			

Sounds

Met this	Date	Reaction: calm / nervous / scared	Notes
Vacuum cleaner (next room first)			
Thunderstorm recording, low volume			
Fireworks recording, low volume			
Garbage truck			
Sirens passing			
Hair dryer			
Blender or food processor			
Doorbell			
Washing machine			
Lawn mower (from inside first)			

Places

Met this	Date	Reaction: calm / nervous / scared	Notes
Vet's waiting room			
Park bench, watching the world			
Coffee shop patio			
Busy street (sitting, watching)			
Friend's house			
Car ride			
Pet store parking lot (in your arms)			
Hardware store entrance			
School playground fence (at a distance)			
Beach or lakeside path			

Other dogs

Met this	Date	Reaction: calm / nervous / scared	Notes
One calm adult dog you know			
Neighbor's mellow dog			
Puppy class (first session)			
Puppy class (second session)			
Dog on a walk — five-second greeting			
Dog on a walk — five-second greeting			
Playdate in a yard, one dog			
Dog behind a fence, watching calmly			

Done with the month? Keep the tracker going into the second month — the window closes, but the learning doesn't. New things still take more work after it closes, and they still work.

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